

This preference for Python 2 comes from the fact that the Python 3 breaks compatibility with Python 2 code. Python 3 was a major update to the programming language and the developers took the opportunity to modernise the language in many ways and get rid of poor decisions made in the past.

The syntax differences between Python 2 and 3 kept a majority of Python libraries from instantly supporting it, and some are yet to support it. While there is an automated tool for converting Python 2 code to Python 3 code, it doesn't work in all cases. The tides are slowly changing as Python 3 gains new and enticing features, and more libraries are ported to it. To further ease this process Python 3.3 brought its syntax closer to 2 and made it easy to make code compatible with both versions. While this might make it sound like they are very different languages, they are really not, it's just the nature of the changes that has caused these issues rather than their intensity or quantity.

With talk of versions out of the way, let's look at the language itself, which is unconventional in many ways. Python takes a very different approach to structuring code, rather than denote blocks of code with curly braces {}, it uses whitespace indentation. Most languages keep the formatting of the code separate from syntax, which means you are likely to run into dozens of different coding styles and arguments over which is better. Python makes the indentation part of the language resulting in more consistent looking code.

Python has a core philosophy, and the more you code in Python the more you tend to understand what makes certain code more or less 'Pythonic'. Long time Python developers can be said to have gotten the 'The Zen of Python'. You can read 'The Zen of Python' on their website, or by typing ``import this`` in a Python console.

Significance

Possibly one of Python's greatest strengths is its simplicity. It is easy to get into it. Python is widely used, to the point that it is present by default if you're running OSX. The same can be said of most Linux distributions. Installing Python on Windows isn't that hard either.

When you reach the limits of what can be accomplished using the Python's inbuilt libraries, there is an extensive ecosystem of packages out there to explore. The PyPI or Python Package Index is a website that lists all Python packages submitted to it. This index of packages is accessible from the command line with the ``easy_install`` and ``pip`` which lets you search this index, download packages and update them if need be. You can